



5.02 Working With Open Pits

1. Purpose

The purpose of the Standard Operating Procedure is to identify the hazards and define the steps in working with open pits.

2. Scope

This procedure is intended for use by all Silverpoint employees .

3. Hazard Identification

- Physical Stress
- Personal Injury
- Fall from Height – Equipment /Personal .
- Ergonomics .
- Slips , Trips and Falls .
- Lifting , Twisting , Pushing , and Pulling .
- Ice, Mud, Weather .
- Hose Kicks .
- Pit Cave Ins.

4. EHS Requirements

- Fire Retardant Coveralls .
- Approved Steel Toed Boots
- Safety Glasses .
- Rubber Gloves .
- Hard Hat .
- Hearing Protection .
- Harness and Lanyard .
- Follow Procedures .
- Lifting Techniques .



- Park Clear and Walk Around .
- Redesign Pit with Warning Signs and Fences .
- Escape Route and Slope to Pit

5. References

- Silverpoint Corporate Codes of Practice
- Alberta OH&S
- Silverpoint Task List
- Silverpoint THA 5.02

6. Procedure unloading and/or loading

6.1. Extra caution must be taken when working around open pits. These include cement pits, shale pits or sumps. If at anytime you are going to these pits with the vacuum truck to dispose of drilling waste, please follow these steps to increase your safety.

6.1.1. Before working near a pit. Take a moment to inspect the pit for hazards. Note any hazards on your safety meeting or if you feel the pit requires it start a new safety meeting. Ensure everyone knows where the remote pit is located, including rig crew and consultant.

These may include but are not limited to:

1. •
- Loose edges
 - 4 straight walls (No sloped walls making exiting impossible)
 - Pit depth
 - Location of pit (Is it remote)
 - No safe exit or entrance

Should any of these hazards be present you are required to wear your harness and lanyard.

6.2. Unloading .

6.2.1. Prepare the unit to dump a load before backing all the way up to the pit. (Approx 5 meters away). Take off valve caps and place them in bumper cabinets or in the unit's toolbox to prevent the loss of caps due to vibrations or bouncing.

6.2.2. Slowly back up to the pit. At no time should your rear bumper ever hang over the edge of the pit if you



need to work on the rear bumper .

- 6.2.3. Finish backing up to the edge of the pit; close enough so that if your spread valve was to drip it would run down into the pit below . Apply the park brakes before releasing the foot brake to eliminate any sliding on a sloping grade leading into the pit .
- 6.2.4. Engage the main P.T.O. and agitator P.T.O. If necessary , turn on work lights .
- 6.2.5. Get out of the truck and chock the wheels and raise the tank one foot past the first stage in the hoist ram . Depending on the slope of the grade leading into the pit, the amount that the tank is raised may have to be decreased or maybe even increased . **Raising the tank to this level and no higher will ensure the safety of you and others** in the case of the unit rolling due to the weight of the load in the tank and the height of the tank . While burping the truck it will move back and forth and side to side .
- 6.2.6. Burp the truck if necessary . Refer to 1.05 Burping the Vacuum Truck .
- 6.2.7. Put 4-way valve into neutral and open 6' spread valve letting fluid to flow freely into pit .
- 6.2.8. If you still have shale or cement in the truck that you cannot vibrate out and need to shovel it out. Do so away from the edge of the pit in front of the spill pile . Construction can always push the pile into the pit later when they back fill the pit. Just choose a location that will not block you from getting to the pit later on . Notify a consultant or technician in this case . If anyone has concerns with shaling out next to the pit, please have them contact the office .
- 6.2.9. Please remember that if you are entering your vacuum tank then you must complete a confined space entry form and follow the proper procedures .
- 6.2.10. Switch the truck over to vacuum and suck all valves clean , leaving the truck on vacuum or neutral once heading back to the rig .

6.3. Loading .

- 6.3.1. Back up or drive beside the pit close enough to hook up the hose , but not so close that you are working over the edge of the pit to hook up hoses or operate the truck .
- 6.3.2. Engage the main PTO and ensure the truck is on Vacuum . Start the Hibon and hook up a hose to a valve and open . If you are working alone and the sump is straight walled , stay clear of the edges and put on your harness and lanyard . Never throw your hose into a pit from the edge . Staying back from the edge push the hose along the ground into the pit .
- 6.3.3. Once the truck is full, pull the hose out from the pit, sucking all the fluid out . If it is too hard to pull the hose out, close the valve and open the cam lock to drain the hose first, then pull the hose out and suck clean .
- 6.3.4. Load the hose back onto the truck and secure .

Remember : if you are in doubt about what to do, call your Supervisor



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